

PLAYBOOK · FOR EVAN SYMONS

Website + Pipeline Agency Playbook

Build the storefront and the front desk so leads do not die in email.

ONE-SENTENCE OFFER

We build your storefront and the follow-up machine behind it.

As of 7 September 2026

Public sources only · Educational, not legal or financial advice

~30 pages · Beginner-friendly · No invented revenue

Read this first

This PDF turns public research into a simple teaching guide. Learn how website shops and CRM/pipeline shops work — and how a small starter can sell both layers as one offer.

Remember: storefront + front desk. One niche. Force next action. No invented dollars.

What is sourced vs estimate

- Numbers with a citation (e.g. Designjoy \$4,995/mo) come from the Brief public sources.
- Items marked [ESTIMATE] are secondary/aggregated — directional, not your quote sheet.
- No invented clients, headcount, or revenue. Company claims labeled company-reported.

How the parts map

A-B	Basics + how agencies get paid
C-D	Finding clients + scaled public examples
E-F	Ops / niches + run your own agency desk
G-H	90-day starter + risks
I + end	Offer templates, glossary, compact sources

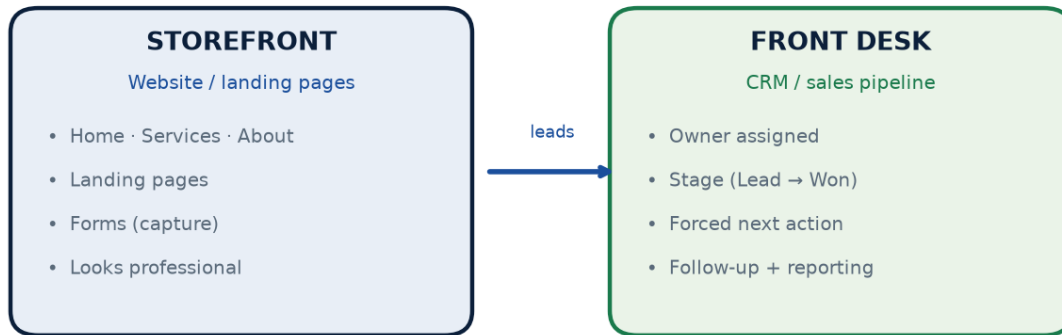
Who this is for

Evan Symons — finance student + server; builds local CRM UIs (Gym Pipeline / ILT Pipeline). Optional geography angles only (Minnesota / Midwest SMB; gyms; training orgs). Not assumed clients.

Two layers people confuse

A website is the storefront. The pipeline/CRM is the front desk that follows up. Sell both as one job.

Storefront vs Front Desk



Sell both as one job: storefront + follow-up machine.

Diagram: public site (storefront) vs CRM desk (front desk).

Plain definitions

Website— The durable online presence (home, services, about, contact).

Funnel / landing— A page built for one conversion: book a call, buy, download.

CRM— Software that stores people/companies so the team shares one truth.

Pipeline— Visual stages a deal moves through (Lead to Qualified to Won).

Automation— Rules that create tasks or stage moves when something happens.

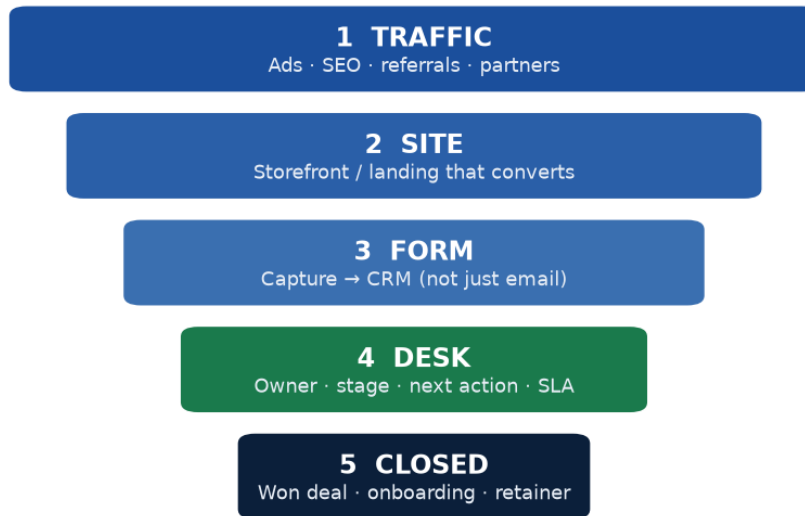
The combined offer

How they combine

Offer line: We build your site and the machine that follows up.

A form dumping to a shared inbox is not a pipeline. A CRM with no traffic is empty. Combined delivery: capture to stage to owner to next action to SLA to reporting.

Offer Stack Funnel



Traffic without a desk = lost leads. Desk without traffic = empty board.

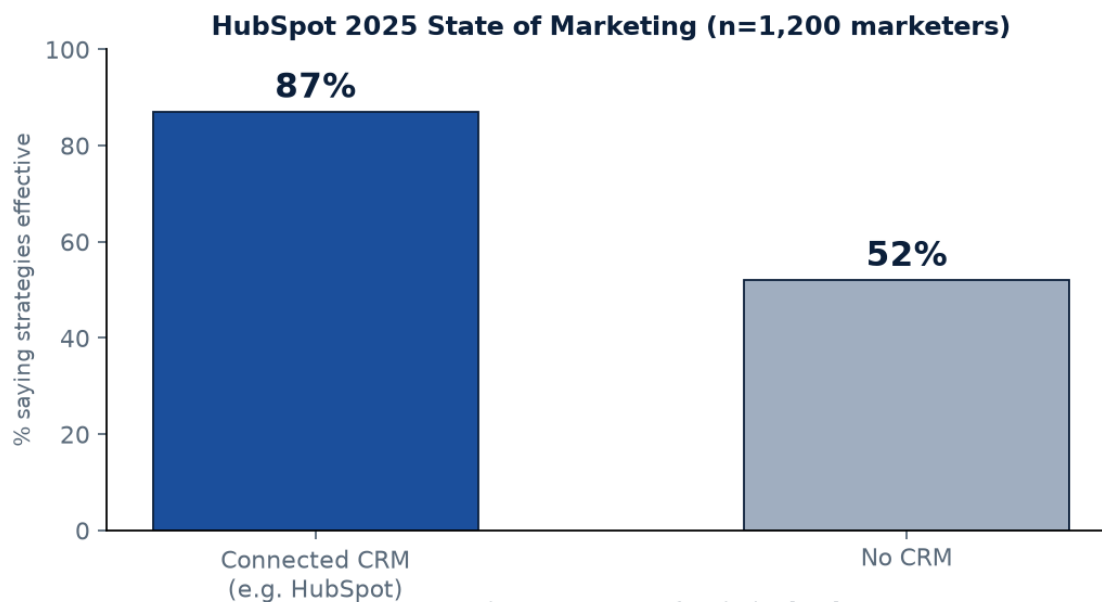
Offer stack: Traffic to Site to Form to Desk to Closed.

Why buyers hire web and forget follow-up

Buyers often hire a web company for a site and separately hire (or never hire) someone to make leads get followed up. The opportunity for a small shop is to sell both layers as one offer.

Demand-side signal (sourced)

HubSpot 2025 State of Marketing (1,200 marketers) reports a large effectiveness gap between marketers with a connected CRM and those without.



Source: HubSpot 2025 State of Marketing [S14]

Source: HubSpot 2025 State of Marketing [S14][S15]. 87% vs 52%.

Takeaway for a starter shop

You do not need to be Elite RevOps. You do need to make the form land on a desk with an owner and a next action — same pattern as Gym/ILT Pipeline UIs: board + record drawer, force next action after every call.

How agencies get paid

Three common models

Agencies make money through projects, retainers, and productized packages (sometimes performance or SaaS+services hybrids). Start simple.

How Agencies Get Paid



Project · Retainer · Productized — three packaging modes.

Plain meaning

- Project — fixed or capped SOW for site build / CRM setup.
- Retainer — monthly WebOps, CRM admin, optimization.
- Productized — fixed scope/price/timeline (or subscription queues).
- Performance — rare for pure web; more common in media/CRO.
- SaaS + services — implement a platform + charge services; sometimes partner commission.

First-party published examples

Use these as landscape anchors — not as Evan quote sheet.

Designjoy — productized design subscription

Monthly Club listed at \$4,995/month (strikethrough \$5,995 shown on site at fetch).

One request at a time; avg ~48-hour delivery; Webflow development as a request type.

Pause/cancel anytime; solo founder model (Brett). Packaging lesson — not a CRM agency.

Source: [S8]

Flow Ninja — Webflow WebOps

Transform investment \$25,000+; FAQ minimums \$45K (Transform) or \$30K (Webflow Dev).

Retainers \$6K/month with 12-month commitment.

Typical payment 50% upfront / 50% at launch — cash-flow pattern worth copying.

Referral incentive published: 10% of first project or 1 month credit.

Source: [S9]

HubSpot partner membership (2026)

Effective July 15, 2026: Partner Program Membership USD \$400/month (annual renew).

Waived if partner HubSpot product subscriptions are $\geq$ \$400/month net after discounts.

Source: [S12][S13]

Clutch / secondary bands [ESTIMATE]

Clutch web design pricing guide and secondary write-ups (verify live):

- Typical project range cited: roughly \$2,000-\$100,000 depending on scope. [S5][S6]
- Most reviewed projects often under \$10,000. [S5][S6]
- Reported average project cost ~\$38,105; avg duration ~7 months; avg monthly ~\$5,280 [ESTIMATE]. [S5][S6]
- Common US hourly band cited: \$100-\$149/hour. [S5][S6]
- Secondary: boutique \$5k-\$25k; mid-size \$15k-\$75k; large \$50k-\$300k+ [ESTIMATE]. [S6]
- Secondary mid-market B2B often \$25k-\$60k with ongoing \$650-\$1,800/mo [ESTIMATE]. [S7]

Typical services menu

Discovery / strategy to brand or marketing site to SEO/content to paid-ads creative handoff to CRM setup and pipelines to automation to training/SOPs to optional ongoing optimization.

Conversion Rate Experts does not publish prices; free strategy session for companies with >\$1M USD online revenue (or funding). [S10] Third-party retainer estimates are not first-party — do not use as fact.

License economics note

Platform licenses (HubSpot etc.) are client cost, not your agency fee. Mid-market stacks can dwarf a small site fee over 3 years — CRM/MA choice is a large TCO driver [ESTIMATE]. [S7][S11]

Channels that show up in public practice

Referrals first. Niche outbound (one ICP). Partner intros. Clutch for credibility. Platform matching later.

Referrals

Client to client. Flow Ninja publishes a referral incentive. Especially strong locally.

Partnerships

Accountants, bookkeepers, ad agencies, coaches — common referral pattern.

Outbound

Cold email/LinkedIn/calls to ICPs. Must respect CAN-SPAM / TCPA if email/SMS.

Inbound SEO/content

Educational content to demos. Classic inbound.

Marketplaces

Clutch (directory/reviews); Upwork (bidding). Secondary credibility, not primary bread.

Partner directories

HubSpot / Webflow / Pipedrive / Shopify directories and matching (later).

Vertical niches

Gyms, dental, EDOs — each may need PMS/gym software + marketing layer.

LinkedIn / local

Relationship selling; strong for MN SMB / gym / EDO niches.

Marketplaces and partner matching

Clutch, Upwork, and directories

- Clutch: research/shortlist tool; reviews drive rank; sponsored placement is not organic Ability-to-Deliver. [S18]
- Upwork: active proposals, fee on transactions, quality highly variable — better as secondary. [S19][S20]
- HubSpot Partner Matching for Gold+ from Jan 15, 2026 (not a guarantee). [S1][S12]
- Webflow Certified/Premium get directory and matching; Foundations is on-ramp with 10% first-year commission. [S23][S4]

Vertical nuance (do not force generic CRM)

Dental often needs PMS + marketing CRM layer. Gyms often need gym management software with CRM features — not generic CRM alone. [S21][S22]

Starter rule: pick one ICP. Become the obvious site + lead desk shop for that niche before chasing every platform directory.

What not to do with lead gen

- Do not blast scraped email/SMS lists.
- Do not promise results you cannot measure.
- Do not treat partner matching as a demand guarantee.

Scaled examples (public facts)

How to read these cards

Headcount/funding only if published by the firm or official partner materials. Otherwise: not published.
Packaging lessons matter more than copying Elite shops.

1 · Designjoy — productized design

Unlimited design requests via monthly subscription; queue; Webflow as a request type.
Public pricing: \$4,995/mo Monthly Club (site also shows \$5,995).
Founded 2017; solo (Brett); HQ Phoenix, AZ. Not a full CRM/pipeline agency.
Lesson: productize scope/price/process. Source: [S8]

2 · Flow Ninja — Webflow WebOps

Transform redesign/replatform; development projects; Operate/Growth retainers.
Public floors/retainers as in Part B; referrals emphasized; Webflow-native since 2015.
Headcount/funding not published on pricing page fetched.
Lesson: clear floors + 50/50 milestones + retainers. Sources: [S9][S3]

3 · Outliant — Orangetheory (Webflow case)

Migrated Orangetheory Fitness site to Webflow (+ ReactJS systems work).
Case claims: migration 2.5 months; 80% site performance increase (company-reported).
Featured in Webflow partner materials. Acquisition mix not published on case page.
Lesson: ecosystem case studies as proof. Sources: [S24][S3]

Lifecycle agencies (aspirational scale)

4 · New Breed Revenue — HubSpot Elite

CRM strategy, RevOps, demand gen, web/CMS on HubSpot Content Hub, integrations, ABM, AI. Claims first-ever Solutions Partner tenure; all listed HubSpot accreditations on About FAQ. Exact headcount/funding not published on About page fetched (do not use third-party blogs). Lesson: ecosystem positioning — not a year-1 competitor. Source: [S25]

5 · SmartBug Media — HubSpot Elite lifecycle

Full lifecycle marketing/sales/RevOps/web/commerce fueled by HubSpot. Founded 2007 (Ryan Malone); remote-first; acquisitions Worth (2021), Chair10 (2023), Globalia (Oct 2023). HubSpot NA Partner of the Year 2021, 2024 (awarded Feb 2025), Global 2018 (company About/awards). About: team grown to nearly 300 SMEs; 500+ 5-star reviews; 1,200+ certifications (company-published). Lesson: large teams come after years/acquisitions — not a year-1 pattern. [S26][S27]

6 · Conversion Rate Experts — CRO consultancy

CRO methodology; A/B testing; names clients such as Amazon, Apple, Google on homepage. Pricing not published. Eligibility for free strategy session: >\$1M online revenue or funding. Brandwidth Group company (footer). Lesson: outcome niche + gate on fit. [S10]

Partner ecosystems

HubSpot Solutions Partner Program

Tiers (as of HubSpot docs updated 2026): Gold, Platinum, Diamond, Elite (+ untiered entry path changing July 2026). Partners implement/optimize/grow; directory; commissions; matching for Gold+.

[S12][S13][S28]

Thresholds to meet by Jan 15, 2027 (points tied to ~\$100 USD MRR):

- Elite: 2,750 sourced / 11,000 total points / $\geq 80\%$ avg GRR; also ≥ 100 employee certifications + invitation.
- Diamond: 1,250 / 3,750 / $\geq 75\%$ GRR.
- Platinum: 425 / 1,275.
- Gold: 115 / 345.

Webflow Certified Partner Program

Rebranded from Experts (Aug 2024; updated Oct 2025). Tiers: Certified / Premium (+ Enterprise).

Foundations (launched Apr 28, 2026): entry tier, 10% commission first year on Site plans/add-ons; path to Certified. Certified: higher commissions (up to 20% per apply page), directory, matching. Global Alliances invite-only (PwC, Slalom, BBDO named in Webflow blog). [S3][S23][S4]

Starter path: learn (Academy / Foundations) before paying membership fees. HubSpot \$400/mo membership starts July 15, 2026 — join when deal flow justifies.

Shopify Partner Program

Plus Partner agency brand sunset Dec 2024; Experts Marketplace sunset Dec 2023. Current Service Partner tiers: Registered to Select to Plus to Premier to Platinum (performance-based). Free join; revenue share on referrals/themes/apps. Exact Q2 2026 dollar thresholds appear in secondary guides — verify in Shopify Partner Tiering Guide before quoting; treat secondary tables as [ESTIMATE/secondary]. [S29][S30]

Pipedrive Solution Partners

For consultants/SIs who market/resell + professional services. Tiers: Authorized, Gold, Platinum. Benefits: commissions, directory, partner portal, demo licenses, MDF eligibility. Newsroom (June 10, 2025): revamped program; 700+ partners in ecosystem (company claim). [S2][S31]

Salesforce Consulting Partners

Application to due diligence to Provisional to Registered path; certifications, co-sell, AppExchange discovery. IDC InfoBrief sponsored by Salesforce cites \$6.93 partner revenue per \$1 Salesforce revenue by 2028 (sponsored research — cite as such). [S32][S33]

Positioning: stay in SMB niche packages. You lose if you bid the same RFP as SmartBug/New Breed. You win if you sell pipeline outcomes to local operators.

Unit economics (high level)

These ops figures are secondary advisory benchmarks — marked [ESTIMATE].

Utilization [ESTIMATE]

Firm-wide utilization often ~65% average (secondary blogs citing BenchPress etc.).

Healthy targets commonly discussed: 65-75% firm-wide; production 75-85%.

Sources: [S34][S35][S36] — not a government survey.

Project vs retainer mix [ESTIMATE]

Secondary ops blogs recommend hybrids such as ~60-70% retainer / 30-40% project.

Retainers improve predictability; projects spike utilization then create bench gaps.

Sources: [S37][S38]

Why niches win

- Repeatable SOPs and reusable templates (site sections, pipeline stages, scripts).
- Faster discovery, clearer proof, better referrals.
- Vertical nuance: gyms need membership ops software; dental needs PMS + marketing layer.

Hire vs subcontract

Hire when utilization is consistently high and cash/retainers cover the seat; subcontract specialists before full-time. HubSpot Elite firms publish large teams only after years/acquisitions — not a year-1 pattern.

[S26]

Systems that protect margin

- SOPs and templates for every repeatable step.
- Productized scopes (Launch Desk / Care Retainer) instead of open consulting.
- Milestone billing (Flow Ninja 50/50 example) for cash flow. [S9]
- Pause features (Designjoy) to reduce overservice. [S8]
- Client-owned platform accounts — document ownership; prefer transfer-friendly stacks.

SBA / small-business hygiene

SBA publishes general small-business guidance and compliance pointers (e.g., CAN-SPAM awareness via FTC cross-links). Use SBA for ops hygiene, not agency rate cards. [S16][S39]

Student + server income constraint: deposits before design; milestones; retainers before hiring. Do not hire ahead of cash.

Metrics to track (ops hygiene)

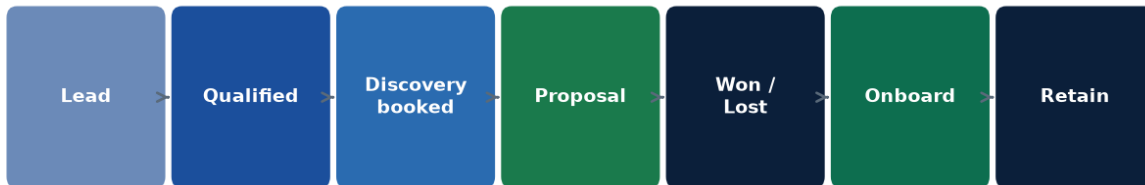
- Lead to discovery rate
- Discovery to proposal
- Proposal win rate
- Average sales cycle
- Deposit collected before build
- Retainer conversion post-launch

Run the agency own pipeline

Same discipline you would sell

Run a desk with forced next actions. Every discovery call ends with a dated next step (send proposal, wait on assets, nurture, close-lost).

Agency's Own Pipeline Stages



Every call ends with a dated next step (force next action).

Educational stage model: Lead to Retain.

Stage model (example)

- 1. Lead — inbound form, referral, Clutch inquiry, LinkedIn reply
- 2. Qualified — ICP fit, budget band, timeline, decision-maker identified
- 3. Discovery booked — paid or tightly scoped diagnostic call
- 4. Proposal — packaged Site + Pipeline SOW
- 5. Won / Lost — reason codes
- 6. Onboarding — access, brand assets, CRM admin, kickoff
- 7. Retain — monthly WebOps / CRM admin / optimization

Force next action after every call

Evan Gym/ILT Pipeline pattern — Transfer to Follow-ups, board + record drawer, force next action after every call — maps cleanly onto agency BD. Do not claim unnamed logos. This is a conceptual tie-in only.

Desk rules (sell this to clients; use it yourself)

- Every lead has an owner.
- Every lead has a stage.
- Every call ends with a dated next step.
- No sticky-note CRM — one shared board.
- SLA: respond to new form fills within a stated window.
- Weekly pipeline review (even if solo — 15 minutes).

What you demo

Publish 1-2 demo desks + screenshots + a short Loom. Show the board and the record drawer. Price a starter package with deposit + milestones. Proof beats adjectives.

Starter playbook overview

Educational 90-day path

Assumes limited time (school + serving). Optional niche angles only. Not a guarantee of clients or revenue.

90-Day Starter Timeline

Days 1-30	Days 31-60	Days 61-90
Niche + offer + proof • Pick one ICP • Default stack • Demo desk + landing • Draft Launch / Care	First conversations • List 50 ICP accounts • 10 partner intros • Soft LinkedIn / Clutch • 8-12 discovery calls	Delivery + retain • SOP after first build • Convert to retainers • Ecosystem ladder • 2-3 testimonials

Educational starter path · school + serving time assumed

Days 1-30 niche/offer · 31-60 conversations · 61-90 delivery/retain.

DO vs DON'T (starter)

DO FIRST	DON'T FIRST
✓ Pick one niche ICP ✓ Productize Site + Lead Desk ✓ Publish 1-2 demo desks + Loom ✓ Price with deposit + milestones ✓ One ecosystem ladder (learn first) ✓ Ask referrals (accountants, ads)	✗ Pitch as HubSpot Elite RevOps ✗ Unpaid open-ended discovery ✗ Promise SMS/email without consent ✗ Invent case-study numbers ✗ Hire ahead of retainers/cash ✗ Build custom CRM when a stack fits

DO first vs DO NOT first — from Brief one-screen implications.

Month one checklist

Step 1

Choose one niche ICP and write a one-sentence offer: For [niche], we ship a conversion site + a lead desk so no inquiry dies.

Step 2

Pick a default stack (examples — not prescriptions): Webflow or Framer/WordPress for site + HubSpot Free/Starter or Pipedrive or HighLevel or niche gym PMS marketing layer.

Step 3

Build a demo pipeline (stages in Part F) and a sample local business landing page. Screenshot board + record drawer.

Step 4

Draft a productized package: Launch (site + CRM pipeline + training) / Care (retainer). Publish price band only when comfortable; else from dollar-X with deposit. Use Flow Ninja-style milestone billing as a cash-flow pattern. [S9]

Do not pitch as full HubSpot Elite RevOps. Do not start unpaid open-ended discovery.

Days 31-90 — Conversations + delivery**Days 31-60 — First conversations**

- List 50 ICP accounts (MN gyms / local services / training orgs — research list, not claimed pipeline).
- Partner outreach: 10 accountants/bookkeepers/ad freelancers.
- Soft channels: LinkedIn posts showing the desk UI; optional Clutch profile (free) once you have real reviews. [S18]
- Run 8-12 discovery calls; sell scoped pilots, not enterprise RevOps.

Days 61-90 — Delivery system + retain

- After first paid build: document SOP (intake to wireframe to build to CRM mapping to training checklist).
- Convert launch clients to small retainers (hosting/CMS edits/CRM hygiene).
- Decide ecosystem ladder: Webflow Foundations (low friction) and/or HubSpot learning; note HubSpot membership fee timing (July 2026). [S23][S12]
- Collect 2-3 detailed testimonials (Clutch interview-style if possible).

Optional niche angles (not assumptions)

- Gyms: Lead capture + tour/trial follow-up desk; integrate or hand off to gym management software for billing/check-in. [S22]
- EDO / training orgs: Familiarity with partner-funded seat motions (ILT-style) can inform how institutions buy — do not claim ILT/EDO clients unless true.
- Dental/local services: Marketing CRM layer beside PMS. [S21]

Risk register (sourced where noted)

Scope creep

Why it hurts: Destroys project margin.

Mitigation: Fixed packages; change orders; transparent scope talks. [S9]

Unpaid discovery

Why it hurts: Infinite strategy, zero cash.

Mitigation: Paid diagnostics or short free calls with hard stop.

Platform lock-in

Why it hurts: Client resentment / migration cost.

Mitigation: Document ownership; prefer client-owned accounts.

DIY competition

Why it hurts: Wix/Squarespace/Framer templates.

Mitigation: Sell pipeline outcomes, not just a website.

Cash flow

Why it hurts: Student + server income constraint.

Mitigation: Deposits (e.g. 50% up front); milestones; retainers before hiring. [S9]

Partner fee treadmill

Why it hurts: HubSpot \$400/mo membership (2026).

Mitigation: Join only when deal flow justifies; Foundations/Academy first. [S12]

Email compliance (CAN-SPAM)

FTC commercial email rules. Penalties up to \$53,088 per email (inflation-adjusted figure in FTC guide note). [S16]

- Accurate headers; non-deceptive subject lines.
- Ad identification; physical postal address.
- Working opt-out; honor within 10 business days.
- Monitor vendors — FTC notes both promoter and sender may be responsible. [S16]

SMS (TCPA / FCC)

Autodialed/prerecorded marketing texts generally need prior express written consent; DNC issues apply. Consent capture on forms; easy STOP; do not blast scraped lists. [S17][S40]

Do not promise SMS/email blasts without consent tooling. Build consent into the form to desk path.

Compliance checklist for client automations

- Client owns the sending domain/subaccount.
- Commercial emails: From, subject, ad ID, postal address, unsubscribe, honor in 10 business days. [S16]
- Marketing SMS: prior express written consent where TCPA/FCC rules apply; honor opt-outs. [S17][S40]
- You are not contracting away liability by using a vendor. [S16]

This playbook is educational research — not legal advice on CAN-SPAM/TCPA.

Package A — Launch Desk (SMB)

Educational example scope — set your own floors from capacity.

Includes (example)

- 5-8 page marketing site OR 1-3 landing pages
- Form to CRM
- Pipeline stages: Lead to Qualified to Booked to Showed to Won/Lost
- Task rules
- 60-90 min training Loom + PDF SOP

Does not include

- Paid ads management
- Custom app development
- Multi-brand enterprise SSO

Cash terms pattern

Deposit before design; balance before publish (mirror public 50/50 norms where appropriate). [S9]

Package B — Site + Nurture Lite

Launch Desk + basic email welcome sequence that is CAN-SPAM compliant (physical address, opt-out). [S16]

Package C — Care Retainer

Monthly hours or fixed deliverables: CMS edits, new landing page/month, CRM hygiene, monthly pipeline review.

Secondary industry blogs often cite marketing retainers in the low thousands per month depending on service — treat as [ESTIMATE], set your own floor from capacity. [S36]

What not to productize in month one

- Full Salesforce multi-cloud implementations
- HubSpot Enterprise architecture for global orgs
- Custom mobile apps — Elite-partner territory [S25][S26]

Competitive positioning (qualitative)

DIY builders— Win if they need follow-up discipline more than templates.

Freelancer web-only— Win if you sell pipeline outcomes — not cheapest homepage.

Productized design— Win if you add CRM/ops Designjoy-like shops do not offer. [S8]

HubSpot Elite— Win by staying in SMB niche packages — lose on same RFP. [S25][S26]

Vertical SaaS— Win if you integrate/hand off cleanly to PMS/gym software. [S21][S22]

Terms used in this playbook

Accreditation (HubSpot)

Rigorous partner capability designation beyond basic certification. [S1]

GRR

Gross Revenue Retention — HubSpot partner retention metric; Diamond/Elite thresholds apply. [S28]

MRR

Monthly recurring revenue (platform subscriptions).

Productized service

Fixed scope/price/process instead of custom consulting.

RevOps

Revenue operations — aligning marketing/sales/service systems and data.

WebOps

Ongoing website operations (updates, CRO, CMS) as a team-as-a-service.

SOW

Statement of work.

ICP

Ideal customer profile.

PMS (dental)

Practice management system (clinical/billing) — distinct from marketing CRM. [S21]

Storefront

The public website / landing experience buyers see.

Front desk

The CRM/pipeline that assigns owner, stage, and next action.

Forced next action

Rule that every call/interaction ends with a dated next step.

Compact URLs from Brief

Full titles in Brief. Verify live — pages change.

S1	hubspot.com/solutions-partners-tiers-and-benefits-2026
S2	pipedrive.com/en/solution-provider-partnership
S3	webflow.com/blog/introducing-webflows-certified-partner-program
S4	webflow.com/certified-partners/apply
S5	clutch.co/web-designers/pricing
S6	pixelean.com/.../web-design-agency-pricing-in-2026/
S7	projectcostestimator.com/blog/b2b-website-cost-2026
S8	designjoy.co
S9	flowninja.com/pricing
S10	conversion-rate-experts.com
S11	flowout.com/blog/website-design-pricing-in-2026-...
S12	hubspot.com/2026-entry-and-tiers-policy-for-hubspot-solutions-partners
S13	hubspot.com/partners/how-tiers-work
S14	HubSpot 2025 State of Marketing PDF (hubspotusercontent)
S15	velocity.digital/.../unpacking-hubspots-2025-state-of-marketing...
S16	ftc.gov/.../can-spam-act-compliance-guide-business
S17	fcc.gov/consumers/guides/stop-unwanted-robocalls-and-texts
S18	clutch.co/methodology
S19	agencyreview.dev/compare/clutch-vs-upwork
S20	agencyreview.dev/marketplace-reviews/upwork-review
S21	netpartners.marketing/crm-for-dentists/
S22	nanoglobals.com/recommended/crm-for-gyms/
S23	webflow.com/updates/webflow-foundations
S24	outliant.com/case-studies/orangetheory
S25	newbreedrevenue.com/about
S26	smartbugmedia.com/about-us
S27	smartbugmedia.com/smartbug-awards
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- S54 [subarnopaul.com/blog/designjoy-review-2026-...](#)
- S55 [wislr.com/articles/shopify-partner-tiers-explained/](#)
- S56 [superwork.co/blog/hubspot-partner-tiers-explained](#)
- S57 [hireinsouth.com/post/clutch-pricing](#)
- S58 [agencyreview.dev/marketplace-reviews/clutch-review](#)
- S59 [impactplus.com/blog/impact-vs-new-breed-vs-smartbug \[OLDER\]](#)
- S60 [molestreet.com/blog/top-hubspot-migration-partners-...-2026](#)

Remember

Storefront + front desk. One niche. Force next action. No invented dollars. Educational only — not legal or financial advice. As of 7 Sep 2026.

One-screen executive summary

The opportunity in one screen

Buyers hire a web company for a site and often never hire anyone to make leads get followed up. Sell both layers: conversion-minded website/funnel and a CRM/pipeline desk.

Do first

- Pick one niche ICP.
- Productize Site + Lead Desk (brochure/landing to form to CRM board with forced next action).
- Publish 1-2 demo desks + screenshots + short Loom; price with deposit + milestones.
- Get on one ecosystem ladder that matches the stack (learn first; fees later).
- Ask for referrals from accountants, ad buyers, and local operators.

Do not do first

- Do not pitch as full HubSpot Elite RevOps against SmartBug/New Breed.
- Do not start unpaid open-ended discovery; do not promise SMS/email without consent tooling.
- Do not invent case-study numbers; do not hire ahead of retainers/cash.
- Do not build custom CRM when HubSpot free / Pipedrive / HighLevel / gym PMS fits — unless niche needs it.

Market is real and crowded. For a solo/small starter: narrow niche + productized site+pipeline package + proof — not competing with Elite shops on enterprise RevOps.

What you can put on a one-pager

Discovery / strategy to marketing site to SEO/content handoff to CRM setup and pipelines to automation to training/SOPs to ongoing optimization (Care Retainer).

Cash discipline checklist

- Deposit before design starts.
- Milestone or 50/50 before publish (public pattern from Flow Ninja). [S9]
- Change orders for scope outside the package.
- Retainer conversation before the launch call ends.
- No build without a signed SOW and paid deposit.

Proof checklist

- Demo desk screenshots (board + drawer).
- Short Loom walkthrough.
- Before/after form to CRM path (even on a fictional local business).
- 2-3 detailed testimonials when earned — never invented.
- Optional Clutch profile once reviews exist. [S18]

This document expands Brief research for education. It is not a get-rich plan and not a claim of existing clients. As of 7 September 2026.

Numbers to remember (Brief only)

- HubSpot 2025 State of Marketing: 87% effective with connected CRM vs 52% without (n=1,200). [S14]
- Designjoy Monthly Club: \$4,995/mo (site also showed \$5,995). [S8]
- Flow Ninja: Transform \$25k+ (FAQ \$45k / \$30k Webflow Dev); retainers \$6k/mo 12-mo; 50/50 pay. [S9]
- HubSpot partner membership: \$400/mo from July 15, 2026 (waiver if >=\$400/mo HubSpot subs). [S12]
- CAN-SPAM: penalties up to \$53,088 per email (FTC guide note); honor opt-out in 10 business days. [S16]
- Webflow Foundations: 10% first-year commission; Certified up to 20% (apply page). [S23][S4]
- SmartBug About: nearly 300 SMEs (company-published). [S26]
- Outliant Orangetheory case: 2.5 months migration; 80% performance increase (company-reported). [S24]
- Clutch averages / secondary bands: [ESTIMATE] — verify live. [S5][S6][S7]
- Utilization / retainer mix: [ESTIMATE] secondary blogs. [S34]-[S38]

Storefront + front desk. One niche. Force next action. No invented dollars.